QM47400 · Spring 2027 · Milestone 00

Round 01 Meeting Requests and Group Contract

DUE	**Sunday, February 7, 2027, 11:59 PM ET**
OPENS	Monday, February 1, 2027
SUBMIT	Three PDFs, uploaded by one member for the whole group: `NN_group_contract.pdf`, `NN_ta_meeting_request.pdf`, `NN_instructor_meeting_request.pdf` (NN is your group number)
GRADING	Completion

What this milestone is for

This milestone gets your group working as a team before the technical work starts, and it has two parts.

The first is your **group contract**. Predictive analytics projects fail more often because a team stops communicating than because the code breaks. Writing down how you will communicate, split the work, make decisions and handle a teammate who goes quiet takes twenty minutes now and can save the project later. It is also the document Professor Moreira refers back to if a dispute about contributions comes up, so the version you submit is the one that counts.

The second is asking for your **Round 01 meetings**, one with the TA and one with Professor Moreira. These meetings test your prediction problem, your data and your modeling plan early, while changing direction is still cheap.

What to do

Part 1: the group contract. Download the Group Contract template (attached on Brightspace) and fill in every section together:

1. members and contact information: name, Purdue email and preferred contact method for everyone;
2. communication: your main channel and how quickly everyone commits to reply;
3. meetings: when your group meets and how meetings get scheduled;
4. roles: who leads on data, modeling, writing, poster design and submission, and how roles rotate;
5. decisions: how you settle a disagreement about direction;
6. work and deadlines: how tasks are assigned and tracked;
7. accountability: what happens when someone misses an internal deadline, and when you bring in Professor Moreira;
8. signatures: every member signs and dates.

Be specific. “We will communicate well” helps nobody. “Slack, replies within 24 hours on weekdays, and we contact Professor Moreira if a member is unreachable for five days” is a rule your group can actually use.

Part 2: the Round 01 meeting requests. Send two emails, one to the TA and one to Professor Moreira, asking for a meeting:

- the **TA meeting** takes place between Monday, February 8 and Sunday, February 21;
- the **meeting with Professor Moreira** takes place between Monday, February 22 and Sunday, February 28.

Each email offers several concrete dates and times, names your course section, and copies every group member. At least one member attends each meeting, and it does not have to be the same person both times.

For this milestone you submit the emails, not the meetings: you confirm that the meetings took place in Milestone 04.

What to submit

One member uploads three PDFs for the whole group: the signed contract, `NN_group_contract.pdf`, and a PDF of each email as sent, `NN_ta_meeting_request.pdf` and `NN_instructor_meeting_request.pdf`. Replace NN with your group number, for example `03_group_contract.pdf`.

How it is graded

This milestone is graded for completion: all three files, by the deadline, with every member's signature on the contract, and each email showing the proposed times, your section and all members copied.

Tips

- Send the emails early. You are asking two people with full calendars for time, and a request sent on the deadline may only get a slot outside your window.
- Offer three or four real slots per email, not "let us know when you are free".
- Use your Purdue email. Outside addresses are more likely to be filtered.
- Do not leave the accountability section vague. It is the section groups most want to skip and the one that matters most when something goes wrong.
- Name your uploader in the contract, so every later submission has an owner.

The Final Project Overview PDF has every date, the meeting rounds, and how the project is graded.